Production artist portfolio:

Noah Michaels

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Hi, I'm Noah, a print production specialist preparing print-ready files for packaging, labels and point-of-sale, including dielines, spot plates, flexo distortion and variable data.

Currently handling variable-data jobs and digital press output at the NC General Assembly print shop.

Selected work, 2019–2026. Every entry lists its plates, structure and whether it was a client job or coursework.

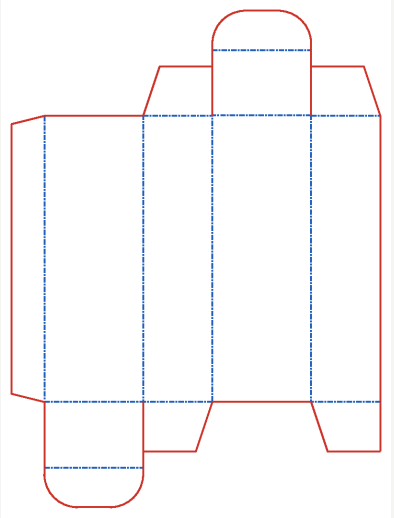
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Folded: front + info panel



Printed flat, CMYK



cut ---- crease

Artios plates

Apple pie tuck box

2020 · GCM 3525 Packaging Design & Production · #packaging #carton

A reverse-tuck carton for a single apple hand pie, built on an ArtiosCAD dieline. Cut, crease and print registration stay on their own named spot plates, so the die-maker and the printer each get exactly what they need.

Product name and net weight sit on the front, in the bottom 30% for the net weight. The panel to its right carries Nutrition Facts, ingredients, the allergen statement and the distributor line. The UPC sits on the bottom flap.

Structure	Reverse tuck end, about 1.9 × 1.3 × 5.4 in
Plates	CMYK + Artios_Cut, Artios_Crease, registration
Required	Net weight, Nutrition Facts, ingredients, allergen, distributor, UPC-A
Software	ArtiosCAD, Illustrator, Photoshop

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Printed and folded



Detail: art and tagline across a fold



Detail: logo on the tuck lid

Creative Printing promo box

2020 · in-house production, Creative Printing, Boone, NC · #packaging #carton

A self-promo cube box for the print shop I worked at. The shop had a lot of extra box stock on hand, so I designed a promo piece to put it to use. A storefront scene wraps all four sides, the tagline runs continuously along the bottom edge across the folds, and the logo sits on the tuck lid.

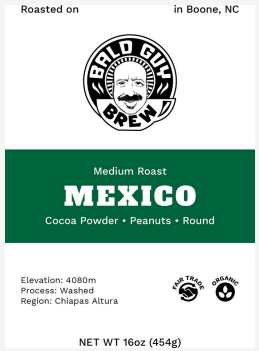
The art has to break cleanly at every crease so the scene and the tagline line up once the box is built.

Structure	Cube carton, about 3 × 3 × 3 in, tuck top, on the shop's surplus box stock
Detail	Wraparound art and copy registered across the folds
Status	Printed and assembled

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Bag label, Colombia



Bag label, Mexico



Counter card, 8.5 × 5.5 in



Imposed 8-up on letter

Bald Guy Brew

2019–2020 · client, not produced · #labels #pos

Bag labels and counter signage for a Boone, NC coffee roaster. One label template per single-origin coffee: the origin data changes, the brand block doesn't, and a blank roast-date field is left for stamping at packing.

The seasonal counter card came in two sizes, with the small one imposed 8-up for short runs.

Fields	Roast, origin, elevation, process, region, notes
Required	Net weight in oz and grams
POS	Counter card, 8.5 × 5.5 in, plus 8-up imposition
Software	InDesign, Illustrator

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Record 001 of 300

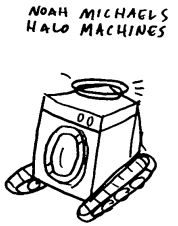


Records 001, 038, 075, 113, 150, 188, 225, 263, 300

Noah Bar

2020 · GCM 4558 Digital Printing Systems · #packaging #vdp

A self-promo chocolate bar wrapper. The Mosaic tool in HP SmartStream Designer generated a different background for every copy from one seed pattern, the same tool Diet Coke used for about 2 million one-off bottle labels in Israel in 2014. I then laid the 300 backgrounds out in InDesign under a locked brand block and output a single 300-page PDF with crops and bleed.



The seed pattern is my Halo Machines mark (first sketch at left), a washing machine with a halo on tank treads. Halo Machines is an anagram of Noah Michaels, same twelve letters, and it was the name I used for my design work before nm.works.

Records	300 from one template
Seed	Halo Machines line mark, recomposed by Mosaic for each copy
Inks	■ PANTONE P 160-7 C ■ PANTONE P 51-9 C
Output	Multi-record PDF, crops & bleed
Software	HP SmartStream Designer (Mosaic), InDesign, Illustrator

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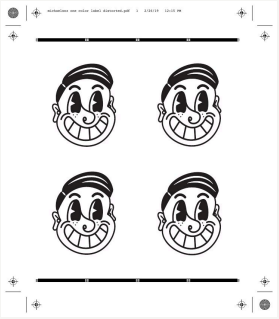
Two-color label, composite



■ Plate 1, PANTONE 116 C



■ Plate 2, Black



One-color, distorted proof



Three-spot set, distorted

Flexo label series

2019 · GRA 2222 & GCM 3882 packaging production · #labels #prepress

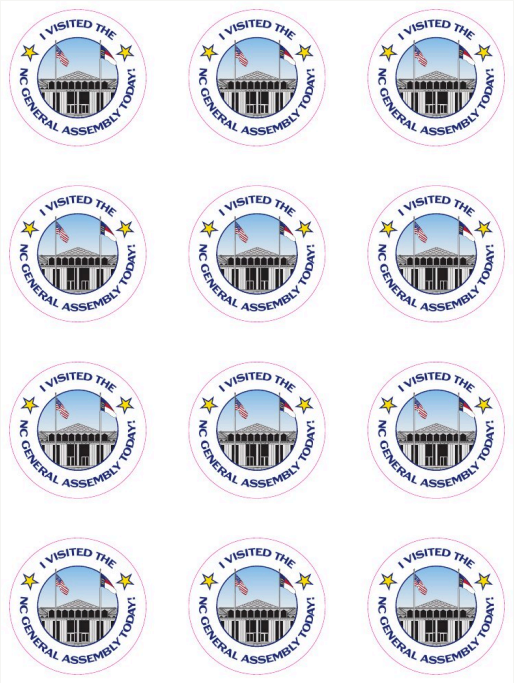
Narrow-web labels prepped for flexo. Each job is separated into named spot plates, and the art is distorted in the around-the-cylinder direction to make up for plate stretch on mounting. Bearer bars and die layouts are matched to the 44- and 88-tooth cylinders for each job.

Process	Narrow-web flexo, roll labels
Inks	1-color; 2-color (PMS 116 C + Black); 3-spot (PMS 169 C, 9380 C, Blue 072 C)
Distortion	92.9% on 44T (5.5 in repeat); 96.5% on 88T (11 in repeat)
Formula	(R − K) / R, K = 2π × (0.067 − 0.005 in) ≈ 0.39 in
Prepress	Bearer bars, step-and-repeat to die, overprint
Software	Illustrator

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Tabletop display, 12 × 20 in



CutContour, 2 in round, 12-up

NC General Assembly

2024 · in-house production · #pos #stickers

Work from the in-house print shop. The career fair display graphic was built to the display vendor's template and corrected to their spec before it went out for print.

The visitor sticker is a 2-inch round, imposed 12-up on a letter sheet, with the cut path on its own CutContour spot plate set to overprint.

Display	Tabletop sign, 12 × 20 in, vendor template
Stickers	2 in round, 12-up; CutContour, 0.25 pt, overprint
Client	NCGA Office of Human Resources
Software	Adobe Creative Cloud

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Mountaineer Printing, App State

12,500 labels on press

2020 · GCM 4591 Advanced Printing & Finishing · #flexo

My first start-to-finish flexo job at Mountaineer Printing, App State's student-run print shop: menu labels for campus dining. I printed two of the four items, 10 and 15 rolls of 500 labels each.

The job covered mounting the plate, registering it to the die-cut, threading the waste matrix and troubleshooting stripping problems on press.

Run	25 rolls × 500 = 12,500 labels
Stock	Platinum semi-gloss adhesive
Size	1 × 2.5 in, die-cut, rewound

11,126-piece VDP mailing

2026 · in-house production · #vdp #python

A constituent postcard mailing, 7 × 5 in, duplex. I wrote a Python script that imposes the merged PDF 2-up on letter with crop marks in cut-and-stack order, then splits it into 500-sheet files, so every stack stays in sequence after cutting.

File	Top stack	Bottom stack
part-01	1–500	501–1000
…	…	…
part-12	11001–11063	11064–11126

```python
# split_postcards_print_job.py · cut-and-stack mapping

piece_start = offset * pieces_per_file
pieces_in_file = min(pieces_per_file, total_pieces - piece_start)
top_count = min(args.sheets_per_file, math.ceil(pieces_in_file / 2))
bottom_count = max(0, pieces_in_file - top_count)
top_start_piece = piece_start + 1
top_end_piece = piece_start + top_count
bottom_start_piece = piece_start + top_count + 1 if bottom_count else None
bottom_end_piece = piece_start + top_count + bottom_count if bottom_count else None

for sheet_index in range(sheets):
    top_piece = (
        top_start_index + sheet_index if sheet_index < top_count else None
    )
    bottom_piece = (
        bottom_start_index + sheet_index if sheet_index < bottom_count else None
    )
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About

Raleigh, NC · open to remote

I'm a print production specialist with 7+ years in prepress, variable-data printing and press work. I currently handle variable-data jobs, digital press output and Adobe production for the in-house print shop at the NC General Assembly. Before that, I worked in web and print production at Creative Printing in Boone, NC.

I focus on the technical side of production: accurate dielines, correctly named spot plates, proper flexo distortion and a clean preflight before a job goes to press.

Software	Illustrator, InDesign, Photoshop, Acrobat; ArtiosCAD (coursework)
Prepress	Dielines, spot separations, overprint, flexo distortion, imposition, preflight & packaging
Data	InDesign Data Merge / VDP, record cleanup, Python scripts for production files
Press	Narrow-web flexo, production digital presses
School	BS Graphic Arts & Imaging Technology, Appalachian State, 2020, including three packaging production courses

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I'm open to packaging and print production roles, remote or in New York. Email is the quickest way to reach me.

— Noah